Business English Negotiations: Practical Dialogues | Business English Learning

1.

Mr.Tom: Good morning, Mary. I'm glad we could meet today to discuss the new contract terms.

Ms.Mary: Good morning, Tom. I'm looking forward to discussing the details and finding common ground.

Mr.Tom: We're particularly interested in revising the delivery schedule to better fit our production timeline.

Ms.Mary: I understand your concern. Can you specify the changes you're proposing?

Mr.Tom: We'd like to move the delivery dates forward by two weeks to ensure we meet our market deadlines.

Ms.Mary: That's quite a shift. We'll need to assess our capacity. Are you flexible on any other terms?

Mr.Tom: We can consider adjusting the payment terms to accommodate the earlier delivery dates.

Ms.Mary: That's a good starting point. How about extending the payment period by 15 days?

Mr.Tom: That could work. However, we'd need a commitment on your end to maintain the product quality.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. Quality is our top priority. Would you also consider increasing the order volume?

Mr.Tom: We're open to that. An increased volume could help us balance the accelerated schedule.

Ms.Mary: Excellent. If we agree on a 10% increase in volume, we can meet the new delivery dates.

Mr.Tom: A 10% increase is manageable. Can we draft these changes into the contract by next week?

Ms.Mary: I'll have my team prepare the draft. Let's schedule a follow-up meeting to review it.

Mr.Tom: That sounds perfect. How does Tuesday at 10 AM work for you?

Ms.Mary: Tuesday at 10 AM works well. I'll send a calendar invite shortly.

Mr.Tom: Great, I look forward to finalizing the details. Thanks for your cooperation, Mary.

Ms.Mary: Thank you, Tom. I'm confident we'll reach a mutually beneficial agreement.

2.

Mr.Tom: Hi Mary, I'd like to discuss the pricing structure for our next project.

Ms.Mary: Hi Tom, certainly. What specific aspects of the pricing would you like to address?

Mr.Tom: We're looking to negotiate a discount for bulk orders. Can we explore this option?

Ms.Mary: Bulk order discounts are feasible. How large an order are you considering?

Mr.Tom: We're planning to order 1,000 units per month over the next year.

Ms.Mary: That's a substantial order. We could offer a 5% discount for that volume.

Mr.Tom: A 5% discount is a good start, but we were hoping for closer to 10%.

Ms.Mary: To reach 10%, we'd need a longer commitment or increased monthly volume.

Mr.Tom: We could extend the contract to 18 months instead of 12. Would that suffice?

Ms.Mary: Extending to 18 months helps. Can we also discuss potential penalties for delays?

Mr.Tom: We can include a clause for penalties, but they should be reasonable. What do you propose?

Ms.Mary: I suggest a 1% penalty for each week of delay, capped at 5%. Does that seem fair?

Mr.Tom: That's acceptable. Additionally, we need assurances on product support and maintenance.

Ms.Mary: We'll provide comprehensive support. Let's outline the specifics in a service level agreement.

Mr.Tom: Agreed. Can we finalize these terms by the end of this week?

Ms.Mary: Yes, I'll have my team draft the revised contract and send it over for your review.

Mr.Tom: Perfect. I'll review it with my team and get back to you promptly.

Ms.Mary: Thanks, Tom. Looking forward to our continued partnership.

3.

Mr.Tom: Mary, I'd like to discuss the scope of our upcoming collaboration.

Ms.Mary: Sure, Tom. What aspects of the scope would you like to review?

Mr.Tom: We need to define the deliverables more clearly to avoid any confusion later.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. Can you specify which deliverables you're referring to?

Mr.Tom: The project reports and performance metrics need more detailed descriptions.

Ms.Mary: I agree. Let's outline the key metrics and reporting frequency.

Mr.Tom: We propose bi-weekly reports with detailed performance analytics.

Ms.Mary: That sounds reasonable. Would you require any specific formats for these reports?

Mr.Tom: A standardized format would be ideal to ensure consistency across all reports.

Ms.Mary: We can develop a template for that. What about the communication protocol?

Mr.Tom: Regular updates via email and a monthly review meeting should suffice.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. We should also set up a dedicated channel for urgent matters.

Mr.Tom: A dedicated channel is a good idea. Should we use Slack or Teams for that?

Ms.Mary: Teams works best for us. We'll set up the channel and share the details with your team.

Mr.Tom: Excellent. Can we also discuss the timeline for the initial project phase?

Ms.Mary: Sure. We propose starting in August with a completion date in December. Does that work for you?

Mr.Tom: Yes, that timeline is feasible. Let's ensure we stick to the milestones.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. I'll prepare a detailed project plan for our next meeting.

4.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to address the logistics for our upcoming shipment.

Ms.Mary: Certainly, Tom. What specific logistics issues are you concerned about?

Mr.Tom: We've had delays in the past due to customs clearance. Can we streamline this process?

Ms.Mary: We can work on that. Perhaps using a different courier service might help.

Mr.Tom: That could be a solution. Do you have any reliable courier recommendations?

Ms.Mary: DHL has been quite reliable for us in the past. Would you like to try them?

Mr.Tom: Yes, let's use DHL for the next shipment and evaluate their performance.

Ms.Mary: Good plan. How about the shipping schedule? Any preferred dates?

Mr.Tom: We'd prefer shipments to go out every Monday to avoid weekend delays.

Ms.Mary: Monday shipments can be arranged. Should we also consider insurance for these shipments?

Mr.Tom: Insurance is essential, especially for high-value items. What coverage do you suggest?

Ms.Mary: I recommend full coverage insurance. It's slightly more expensive but provides better security.

Mr.Tom: Full coverage sounds prudent. Can we also include tracking details for each shipment?

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. We'll ensure tracking details are shared promptly with your team.

Mr.Tom: Great. Lastly, can we review the packaging standards to prevent damage during transit?

Ms.Mary: Yes, we can use reinforced packaging and additional padding for fragile items.

Mr.Tom: Perfect. Let's document these changes and implement them for the next shipment.

Ms.Mary: Will do. I'll update our logistics plan and send it over for your approval.

5.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to discuss the warranty terms for the new product line.

Ms.Mary: Sure, Tom. What warranty terms are you looking to modify?

Mr.Tom: We're considering extending the warranty period from one year to two years.

Ms.Mary: Extending the warranty is possible, but we'd need to review the cost implications.

Mr.Tom: We're prepared to negotiate the pricing if the extended warranty is included.

Ms.Mary: That's reasonable. How about the terms for warranty claims and replacements?

Mr.Tom: We'd like faster processing times for claims, ideally within two weeks.

Ms.Mary: We can aim for a two-week turnaround, but some cases might require more time.

Mr.Tom: Understood. Can we also specify the coverage for wear and tear versus manufacturing defects?

Ms.Mary: Yes, we should distinguish between those. Manufacturing defects will have full coverage, while wear and tear will have limited coverage.

Mr.Tom: That works for us. Can we also offer an optional extended warranty for an additional fee?

Ms.Mary: Offering an optional extended warranty is a good idea. We'll need to set the fee structure.

Mr.Tom: We can work on the fee structure together. Additionally, let's include a customer support hotline for warranty issues.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. We'll set up a dedicated hotline. Can we also discuss return policies?

Mr.Tom: Sure. We propose a 30-day return policy for unopened products and a 15-day policy for opened but unused products.

Ms.Mary: That's fair. We'll draft these terms and get back to you with the revised warranty policy.

Mr.Tom: Thank you, Mary. I look forward to finalizing these terms soon.

Ms.Mary: Thanks, Tom. Let's ensure our customers get the best support possible.

6.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to talk about the marketing strategy for the new product launch.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely, Tom. What key points do you want to address?

Mr.Tom: We need a robust online presence. Can we allocate more budget to digital marketing?

Ms.Mary: Increasing the digital marketing budget is a smart move. How much are you proposing?

Mr.Tom: I suggest increasing the budget by 20% to cover social media, SEO, and influencer partnerships.

Ms.Mary: That sounds reasonable. What platforms do you want to focus on?

Mr.Tom: Primarily Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn. These platforms have our target audience.

Ms.Mary: Good choice. We should also consider a content marketing strategy to engage users.

Mr.Tom: Agreed. Let's create blog posts, videos, and infographics to share on our platforms.

Ms.Mary: Perfect. Do you have any specific campaigns or themes in mind?

Mr.Tom: Yes, we should focus on highlighting the unique features and benefits of the new product.

Ms.Mary: That's effective. Should we also run a pre-launch teaser campaign to build anticipation?

Mr.Tom: Absolutely. Teaser campaigns can create buzz. Let's start a month before the official launch.

Ms.Mary: I agree. We should also collaborate with industry influencers to broaden our reach.

Mr.Tom: Great idea. Can you handle the influencer outreach and negotiations?

Ms.Mary: Yes, I'll take care of that. Can we also plan a launch event?

Mr.Tom: Definitely. A virtual launch event could attract a larger audience. Let's set a date for it.

Ms.Mary: Sounds good. I'll coordinate with the team and finalize the details.

7.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to renegotiate the terms of our partnership agreement.

Ms.Mary: Sure, Tom. What aspects of the partnership would you like to revisit?

Mr.Tom: We need to adjust the revenue sharing ratio to reflect our increased investment.

Ms.Mary: I understand. What new ratio are you proposing?

Mr.Tom: We're proposing a 60-40 split in our favor due to our higher financial commitment.

Ms.Mary: That's a significant change. Can you provide more details on your investment increase?

Mr.Tom: We've increased our investment by 30% to support new developments and marketing.

Ms.Mary: That's substantial. We'll need to review our budget and see if this ratio is feasible.

Mr.Tom: I appreciate that. We're also willing to offer additional support in operations.

Ms.Mary: Additional operational support is valuable. Can we specify the areas you'll assist in?

Mr.Tom: We can provide support in logistics, customer service, and technical assistance.

Ms.Mary: That's comprehensive. Let's draft a revised agreement that includes these changes.

Mr.Tom: Agreed. Can we also discuss the duration of the new agreement?

Ms.Mary: How about a three-year term with an option for renewal based on performance?

Mr.Tom: A three-year term works. We should also set clear performance metrics for the renewal.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. Let's outline these metrics in the agreement to ensure transparency.

Mr.Tom: Perfect. Can we finalize this by next Friday?

Ms.Mary: Yes, I'll have the revised draft ready for your review by then.

8.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to discuss the intellectual property rights for our joint project.

Ms.Mary: Certainly, Tom. What specific IP rights are we addressing?

Mr.Tom: We need to clarify the ownership of patents and copyrights for the developed technology.

Ms.Mary: I agree. How do you propose we divide the IP rights?

Mr.Tom: We propose a 50-50 split for any patents and copyrights resulting from the project.

Ms.Mary: That seems fair. Can we also outline the process for filing and maintaining these IP rights?

Mr.Tom: Yes, we should specify that both parties will share the costs and responsibilities equally.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. What about any pre-existing IP each party brings to the project?

Mr.Tom: Pre-existing IP should remain with the original owner, but we can license it to each other as needed.

Ms.Mary: That's a good approach. Should we also include clauses for potential IP disputes?

Mr.Tom: Yes, we need a clear dispute resolution process to handle any conflicts that arise.

Ms.Mary: Mediation followed by arbitration if necessary could be effective. What do you think?

Mr.Tom: Mediation and arbitration sound fair. Can we also discuss the duration of IP rights protection?

Ms.Mary: Standard durations based on jurisdiction should apply, but we can include a review clause.

Mr.Tom: Agreed. Let's draft these terms and have our legal teams review them.

Ms.Mary: I'll coordinate with our legal team and send the draft for your review.

9.

Mr.Tom: Mary, I'd like to discuss the performance evaluation criteria for our team members.

Ms.Mary: Of course, Tom. What key criteria do you think we should include?

Mr.Tom: We should focus on productivity, quality of work, and adherence to deadlines.

Ms.Mary: Those are crucial. How about including team collaboration and innovation as well?

Mr.Tom: Good point. Collaboration and innovation are important for our project's success.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. Should we also set individual and team goals to measure performance?

Mr.Tom: Yes, individual and team goals will provide a balanced assessment. What about feedback mechanisms?

Ms.Mary: Regular feedback sessions and 360-degree reviews could be effective. What do you think?

Mr.Tom: I like the idea of 360-degree reviews. They provide comprehensive insights.

Ms.Mary: Exactly. Should we conduct these reviews quarterly or bi-annually?

Mr.Tom: Quarterly reviews would help us address issues promptly and keep everyone on track.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. We should also offer professional development opportunities based on the reviews.

Mr.Tom: Yes, training and development are essential. Can we allocate a budget for this?

Ms.Mary: We can set aside a portion of our budget for training. How about 5% of the total project budget?

Mr.Tom: That's reasonable. Let's ensure these criteria are clearly communicated to all team members.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. I'll draft a performance evaluation plan and share it with you.

10.

Mr.Tom: Mary, we need to finalize the partnership agreement for the upcoming fiscal year.

Ms.Mary: Sure, Tom. What key points do you want to address in the agreement?

Mr.Tom: We need to review the profit-sharing model and operational responsibilities.

Ms.Mary: Agreed. What changes are you proposing to the profit-sharing model?

Mr.Tom: We're suggesting a shift to a 55-45 split, with us taking the larger share due to our increased investment.

Ms.Mary: That's a considerable change. Can you provide details on the increased investment?

Mr.Tom: We've committed additional resources towards R&D and marketing initiatives.

Ms.Mary: Understood. We'll need to assess how this affects our overall budget.

Mr.Tom: I appreciate that. We're also proposing to take on more operational tasks to support the partnership.

Ms.Mary: Additional operational support is beneficial. Can we outline the specific tasks?

Mr.Tom: We'll handle logistics, customer service, and technical support to ensure smooth operations.

Ms.Mary: That's helpful. Let's include these details in the revised agreement.

Mr.Tom: Agreed. Can we also discuss the duration and renewal terms of the agreement?

Ms.Mary: How about a three-year term with an option for renewal based on performance and mutual agreement?

Mr.Tom: A three-year term works. We should also include clear performance metrics for renewal consideration.

Ms.Mary: Absolutely. Let's finalize these terms and have our legal teams review the agreement.

Mr.Tom: Perfect. Can we aim to finalize this by the end of the month?

Ms.Mary: Yes, I'll have the revised draft ready for your review by then.